

Theme 1: Business, Strategy & Decision Making

1. Pragmatic

- **Meaning:** Practical and realistic rather than theoretical.
- **Usage 1:** Taking a **pragmatic** approach helped the team meet the tight deadline.
- **Usage 2:** The manager made a **pragmatic** decision to cut down on extra features.

2. Acumen

- **Meaning:** The ability to make good judgments and quick decisions.
- **Usage 1:** Her business **acumen** helped the startup scale rapidly.
- **Usage 2:** The engineer's technical **acumen** was vital during the server crash.

3. Mitigate

- **Meaning:** To make something less severe, serious, or painful.
- **Usage 1:** We need a backup plan to **mitigate** the risk of data loss.
- **Usage 2:** Cloud storage can **mitigate** physical hardware dependency.

4. Feasible

- **Meaning:** Possible to do easily or conveniently.
- **Usage 1:** Implementing this feature within two days is not **feasible**.
- **Usage 2:** The tech lead gave a **feasible** solution to the client's problem.

5. Ambivalent

- **Meaning:** Having mixed feelings or contradictory ideas about something.
- **Usage 1:** Management is **ambivalent** about changing the current work hours.
- **Usage 2:** He felt **ambivalent** about accepting the promotion because of the relocation.

6. Arbitrary

- **Meaning:** Based on random choice or personal whim, rather than any reason or system.
- **Usage 1:** The project deadlines seemed completely **arbitrary** to the developers.
- **Usage 2:** Do not make **arbitrary** changes to the source code without approval.

7. Leverage

- **Meaning:** To use something to its maximum advantage.
- **Usage 1:** We should **leverage** open-source tools to reduce project costs.
- **Usage 2:** The firm aims to **leverage** AI to improve customer service operations.

8. Catalyst

- **Meaning:** An event or person that causes a significant change or action.
- **Usage 1:** The new CEO was the **catalyst** for the company's digital transformation.
- **Usage 2:** This software upgrade will act as a **catalyst** for faster processing.

9. Stringent

- **Meaning:** Strict, precise, and exacting.
- **Usage 1:** TCS follows **stringent** security protocols to protect client data.
- **Usage 2:** The application had to pass **stringent** quality checks before launch.

10. Viable

- **Meaning:** Capable of working successfully; feasible.
- **Usage 1:** Finding a **viable** alternative to the current database is our top priority.
- **Usage 2:** The startup proved to be a commercially **viable** business model.

11. Consensus

- **Meaning:** A general agreement.
- **Usage 1:** After a three-hour meeting, the board finally reached a **consensus**.
- **Usage 2:** There is no clear **consensus** on which programming language is better for this project.

12. Deference

- **Meaning:** Polite submission and respect.
- **Usage 1:** In **deference** to the client's wishes, we revised the entire design.
- **Usage 2:** The junior developer listened to the architect with deep **deference**.

13. Empirical

- **Meaning:** Based on verifiable observation or experience rather than theory.
- **Usage 1:** We need **empirical** evidence before we can declare the system bug-free.
- **Usage 2:** The research is backed by **empirical** data collected over five years.

14. Impediment

- **Meaning:** A hindrance or obstruction in doing something.
- **Usage 1:** A lack of funding was the main **impediment** to our research.
- **Usage 2:** Communication gaps act as a major **impediment** in agile teams.

15. Inundate

- **Meaning:** To overwhelm someone with things or people to be dealt with (flooded).
- **Usage 1:** The helpdesk was **inundated** with complaints after the system outage.

- **Usage 2:** Do not **inundate** your supervisor with too many emails at once.

16. Paramount

- **Meaning:** More important than anything else; supreme.
- **Usage 1:** Data privacy is of **paramount** importance to our clients.
- **Usage 2:** Maintaining code quality should be **paramount** during development.

17. Requisite

- **Meaning:** Made necessary by particular circumstances or regulations.
- **Usage 1:** She possesses the **requisite** skills required for the cloud engineer role.
- **Usage 2:** Please ensure you have all the **requisite** permissions before deploying the patch.

18. Surpass

- **Meaning:** To exceed or be greater than.
- **Usage 1:** This quarter's profits are expected to **surpass** last year's records.
- **Usage 2:** The performance of the new algorithm managed to **surpass** our expectations.

19. Unprecedented

- **Meaning:** Never done or known before.
- **Usage 1:** The rapid shift to remote work was **unprecedented** in corporate history.
- **Usage 2:** The website faced an **unprecedented** amount of traffic on Black Friday.

20. Benchmark

- **Meaning:** A standard or point of reference against which things may be compared.
- **Usage 1:** This software sets a new **benchmark** for speed and user experience.
- **Usage 2:** We use industry standards to **benchmark** our security compliance.

21. Complacent

- **Meaning:** Showing smug or uncritical satisfaction with oneself or one's achievements (overconfident).
- **Usage 1:** We cannot afford to become **complacent** just because we won this contract.
- **Usage 2:** Market leaders often fail when they grow **complacent** about innovation.

22. Discretion

- **Meaning:** The freedom to decide what should be done in a particular situation.
- **Usage 1:** Managers have the **discretion** to award bonuses for exceptional work.
- **Usage 2:** Employee records must be handled with the utmost **discretion**.

23. Expedite

- **Meaning:** To make an action or process happen sooner or be accomplished more quickly.
- **Usage 1:** Please email the manager to **expedite** the approval of our budget.
- **Usage 2:** Automation can drastically **expedite** the software testing phase.

24. Liability

- **Meaning:** The state of being responsible for something, especially by law; a disadvantage.
- **Usage 1:** An unpatched security loophole is a massive **liability** for the company.
- **Usage 2:** Using outdated tech stacks can become a major **liability** over time.

25. Oversight

- **Meaning:** An unintentional failure to notice or do something; or supervision.
- **Usage 1:** Missing the spelling error in the contract was an unfortunate **oversight**.
- **Usage 2:** The senior engineer provided **oversight** for the entire migration project.

Theme 2: Systems, Patterns & Processes

These words are highly common in Reading Comprehension/Para-Recall passages focusing on tech infrastructure, trends, and processes.

26. Aberration

- **Meaning:** A departure from what is normal, usual, or expected.
- **Usage 1:** The sudden system lag was a temporary **aberration** caused by a network spike.
- **Usage 2:** For a student who always scores 100, getting a 60 is an **aberration**.

27. Convoluted

- **Meaning:** Extremely complex and difficult to follow.
- **Usage 1:** The legacy system code was too **convoluted** for new developers to understand.
- **Usage 2:** His **convoluted** explanation left the client more confused than before.

28. Disparate

- **Meaning:** Essentially different in kind; not allowing comparison.
- **Usage 1:** It is difficult to merge data from two entirely **disparate** software platforms.
- **Usage 2:** The project team was made of individuals from **disparate** cultural backgrounds.

29. Ephemeral

- **Meaning:** Lasting for a very short time.
- **Usage 1:** Social media trends are highly **ephemeral**, changing every week.
- **Usage 2:** The error message was **ephemeral**, disappearing before I could screenshot it.

30. Obfuscate

- **Meaning:** To render obscure, unclear, or unintelligible.
- **Usage 1:** Companies sometimes use complex legal jargon to **obfuscate** their true policies.
- **Usage 2:** Programmers intentionally **obfuscate** source code to prevent piracy.

31. Redundant

- **Meaning:** Not or no longer needed or useful; superfluous.
- **Usage 1:** Regular cloud backups ensure that your data is stored in a **redundant** manner for safety.
- **Usage 2:** Automation has made several manual data-entry jobs completely **redundant**.

32. Sporadic

- **Meaning:** Occurring at irregular intervals or only in a few places; scattered.
- **Usage 1:** The server experienced **sporadic** power outages throughout the weekend.
- **Usage 2:** His attendance in the training sessions was **sporadic** at best.

33. Tangible

- **Meaning:** Perceptible by touch; clear and definite; real.
- **Usage 1:** The new marketing strategy produced **tangible** results within a month.
- **Usage 2:** Unlike software, hardware components are **tangible** assets.

34. Volatile

- **Meaning:** Liable to change rapidly and unpredictably, especially for the worse.
- **Usage 1:** RAM is a **volatile** memory format that clears out when the PC shuts down.
- **Usage 2:** The stock market has been highly **volatile** due to global tensions.

35. Anachronism

- **Meaning:** Something belonging to a period other than that in which it exists (old-fashioned).
- **Usage 1:** Using dial-up internet in 2026 is a complete **anachronism**.
- **Usage 2:** The appearance of a modern watch in the medieval movie was an **anachronism**.

36. Dichotomy

- **Meaning:** A contrast or division between two entirely opposed or different things.
- **Usage 1:** There is a clear **dichotomy** between theoretical coding and real-world software engineering.
- **Usage 2:** The article discusses the **dichotomy** of work-life balance in tech.

37. Incipient

- **Meaning:** In an initial stage; beginning to happen or develop.
- **Usage 1:** The monitoring tool detected an **incipient** system failure and alerted us.

- **Usage 2:** There is an **incipient** demand for eco-friendly tech gadgets in the market.

38. Manifest

- **Meaning:** Clear or obvious to the eye or mind; to display or show.
- **Usage 1:** System bugs often **manifest** as slow loading speeds or application crashes.
- **Usage 2:** The team's hard work became **manifest** when they won the best project award.

39. Omnipresent

- **Meaning:** Widely or constantly encountered; widespread.
- **Usage 1:** Smartphones have become **omnipresent** in modern human society.
- **Usage 2:** The fear of cyber threats is **omnipresent** among online banking users.

40. Resilient

- **Meaning:** Able to withstand or recover quickly from difficult conditions.
- **Usage 1:** Our network infrastructure is **resilient** enough to handle massive traffic spikes.
- **Usage 2:** A **resilient** employee adapts easily to sudden organizational shifts.

41. Transitory

- **Meaning:** Not permanent; brief.
- **Usage 1:** Do not panic over this bug; it is a **transitory** issue during the server migration.
- **Usage 2:** Market dips are usually **transitory** and recover over time.

42. Ubiquitous

- **Meaning:** Present, appearing, or found everywhere.
- **Usage 1:** Artificial Intelligence is becoming **ubiquitous** across all business sectors.
- **Usage 2:** Wi-Fi connectivity is now expected to be **ubiquitous** in public spaces.

43. Assimilate

- **Meaning:** Take in information, ideas, or culture and understand fully.
- **Usage 1:** It takes time for freshers to **assimilate** the complex work culture of an IT giant.
- **Usage 2:** The system was designed to **assimilate** data from multiple social media streams.

44. Cohesive

- **Meaning:** Characterized by or causing organization and unity; working well together.
- **Usage 1:** A **cohesive** team can easily outperform a group of brilliant individuals working apart.
- **Usage 2:** The UI components must fit together into a single, **cohesive** design language.

45. Fluctuate

- **Meaning:** Rise and fall irregularly in number or amount.
- **Usage 1:** Internet speeds can **fluctuate** based on weather conditions and network load.
- **Usage 2:** Gold prices continue to **fluctuate** daily due to global economic factors.

46. Integral

- **Meaning:** Necessary to make a whole complete; essential.
- **Usage 1:** Regular testing is an **integral** part of the software development lifecycle.
- **Usage 2:** Customer feedback plays an **integral** role in product refinement.

47. Perpetuate

- **Meaning:** Make something (typically an undesirable situation or unfounded belief) continue indefinitely.
- **Usage 1:** Using outdated training modules will only **perpetuate** inefficient coding habits.
- **Usage 2:** Spreading rumors can **perpetuate** unnecessary panic within the workspace.

48. Prevalent

- **Meaning:** Widespread in a particular area or at a particular time.
- **Usage 1:** Python is highly **prevalent** in the field of data science and machine learning.
- **Usage 2:** Phishing scams have become increasingly **prevalent** over the past year.

49. Synchronize

- **Meaning:** Cause to occur or operate at the same time or rate.
- **Usage 1:** Cloud storage services automatically **synchronize** files across all your devices.
- **Usage 2:** The development and testing teams must **synchronize** their schedules for a smooth release.

50. Synthetic

- **Meaning:** Made by chemical synthesis, especially to imitate a natural product; artificial.
- **Usage 1:** Machine learning models are often trained on **synthetic** data to preserve privacy.
- **Usage 2:** The laboratory specialized in creating high-quality **synthetic** fibers.

Theme 3: Communication, Tone & Expression

Essential for understanding Sentence Completion options and hitting the perfect vocabulary marks in TCS Email Writing.

51. Cogent

- **Meaning:** Clear, logical, and convincing.
- **Usage 1:** The architect gave a **cogent** explanation for choosing cloud architecture.
- **Usage 2:** Her proposal was so **cogent** that the client signed the deal on the spot.

52. Equivocal

- **Meaning:** Open to more than one interpretation; ambiguous.
- **Usage 1:** The test results were **equivocal**, so we had to run them again.
- **Usage 2:** Avoid giving **equivocal** answers during your TCS technical interview.

53. Laconic

- **Meaning:** Using very few words; brief and to the point.
- **Usage 1:** His **laconic** style of writing emails saves a lot of time for managers.
- **Usage 2:** The CTO's **laconic** reply simply read: "Approved."

54. Garrulous

- **Meaning:** Excessively talkative, especially on trivial matters.
- **Usage 1:** A **garrulous** speaker can easily derail a professional business meeting.
- **Usage 2:** The **garrulous** customer spent half an hour talking about irrelevant complaints.

55. Hackneyed

- **Meaning:** Lacking significance through having been overused; unoriginal.
- **Usage 1:** Terms like "think outside the box" have become corporate, **hackneyed** phrases.
- **Usage 2:** The movie's plot was filled with predictable, **hackneyed** tropes.

56. Lucid

- **Meaning:** Expressed clearly; easy to understand.
- **Usage 1:** The documentation was so **lucid** that even non-tech clients understood the project.
- **Usage 2:** Write your code in a **lucid** manner so others can easily maintain it.

57. Concise

- **Meaning:** Giving a lot of information clearly and in a few words.
- **Usage 1:** Keep your project status emails **concise** and bulleted.
- **Usage 2:** A **concise** summary is much better than a ten-page report.

58. Eloquent

- **Meaning:** Fluent or persuasive in speaking or writing.
- **Usage 1:** Her **eloquent** presentation won over the entire panel of judges.
- **Usage 2:** You don't need to be poetically **eloquent** in emails; just be clear and professional.

59. Explicit

- **Meaning:** Stated clearly and in detail, leaving no room for confusion or doubt.
- **Usage 1:** The client gave **explicit** instructions not to change the font color.

- **Usage 2:** The error log provides **explicit** details on why the crash occurred.

60. Implicit

- **Meaning:** Implied though not plainly expressed.
- **Usage 1:** There was an **implicit** agreement that the team would work extra hours during deployment.
- **Usage 2:** Trust is an **implicit** requirement in any healthy professional relationship.

61. Objective

- **Meaning:** Not influenced by personal feelings or opinions in considering and representing facts.
- **Usage 1:** An interviewer must remain **objective** while assessing a candidate's skills.
- **Usage 2:** Please provide an **objective** analysis of the software's performance flaws.

62. Subjective

- **Meaning:** Based on or influenced by personal feelings, tastes, or opinions.
- **Usage 1:** UI design can be quite **subjective**, as different clients prefer different colors.
- **Usage 2:** Performance reviews shouldn't be **subjective**; they should rely on real data.

63. Ambiguous

- **Meaning:** Open to more than one interpretation; having a double meaning.
- **Usage 1:** The error message "An error occurred" is highly **ambiguous** and unhelpful.
- **Usage 2:** Please clarify your email; the requirements you listed are a bit **ambiguous**.

64. Candor

- **Meaning:** The quality of being open and honest in expression; frankness.
- **Usage 1:** The manager appreciated the engineer's **candor** about missing the deadline.
- **Usage 2:** We must speak with **candor** during retrospective meetings to fix process issues.

65. Curtail

- **Meaning:** Reduce in extent or quantity; impose a restriction on.
- **Usage 1:** The company decided to **curtail** travel expenses to save operational budgets.
- **Usage 2:** Please **curtail** long introductions and get straight to the point in your report.

66. Emphasize

- **Meaning:** Give special importance or prominence to something in speaking or writing.
- **Usage 1:** In your resume, you should **emphasize** your hands-on coding projects.
- **Usage 2:** The training module will **emphasize** cybersecurity awareness.

67. Hyperbole

- **Meaning:** Exaggerated statements or claims not meant to be taken literally.
- **Usage 1:** Claiming that a software tool will "solve all world problems" is pure **hyperbole**.
- **Usage 2:** Avoid **hyperbole** in business proposals; stick strictly to real numbers.

68. Ornate

- **Meaning:** Highly elaborated, adorned, or excessively complicated (in language or style).
- **Usage 1:** Professional emails should be simple, not written in **ornate** or poetic prose.
- **Usage 2:** The website's **ornate** design look beautiful but made the loading times terrible.

69. Persuasive

- **Meaning:** Good at convincing someone to do or believe something through reasoning.
- **Usage 1:** The sales pitch was highly **persuasive**, leading to a multi-year deal.
- **Usage 2:** Presenting data charts is a **persuasive** way to request additional resources.

70. Redundant

- **Meaning:** Expressed more than once using different words; words that add nothing new.
- **Usage 1:** Saying "return back" is **redundant**; just using "return" is correct.
- **Usage 2:** Remove the **redundant** sentences from your essay to make it cleaner.

71. Rhetoric

- **Meaning:** Language designed to have a persuasive or impressive effect on its audience, but often regarded as lacking in sincerity or meaningful content.
- **Usage 1:** Empty corporate **rhetoric** won't satisfy employees who want salary hikes.
- **Usage 2:** Focus on real technical features instead of marketing **rhetoric**.

72. Subtle

- **Meaning:** So delicate or precise as to be difficult to analyze or describe.
- **Usage 1:** There was a **subtle** bug in the logic that only appeared under heavy server loads.
- **Usage 2:** The updated UI features **subtle** color shifts that look very professional.

73. Succinct

- **Meaning:** Briefly and clearly expressed (especially of something written or spoken).
- **Usage 1:** Give me a **succinct** update on the bug fixes before the client call.
- **Usage 2:** His **succinct** presentation covered all vital statistics in under five minutes.

74. Terminology

- **Meaning:** The body of terms used with a particular technical application, subject, or profession.
- **Usage 1:** Computer Science graduates should be comfortable using cloud **terminology**.

- **Usage 2:** The client struggled to understand the highly complex **terminology** used by the developers.

75. Terse

- **Meaning:** Sparing in the use of words; abrupt.
- **Usage 1:** Her **terse** email reply read: "No, fix it."
- **Usage 2:** A **terse** command-line response indicates that the operation failed.

Theme 4: Quality, Standards & Professional Behavior

Perfect for understanding reading comprehension tone and constructing structured answers in behavioral sections.

76. Alacrity

- **Meaning:** Brisk and cheerful readiness.
- **Usage 1:** The team accepted the tough new client project with absolute **alacrity**.
- **Usage 2:** She completed the emergency server fix with impressive **alacrity**.

77. Capricious

- **Meaning:** Given to sudden and unaccountable changes of mood or behavior; unpredictable.
- **Usage 1:** The stock market can be quite **capricious**, reacting violently to rumors.
- **Usage 2:** It is hard to work under a manager who makes **capricious** policy shifts.

78. Fastidious

- **Meaning:** Very attentive to and concerned about accuracy, details, or cleanliness.
- **Usage 1:** As a **fastidious** tester, he uncovers bugs that others completely miss.
- **Usage 2:** She is **fastidious** about maintaining clean indentation in her source code.

79. Imperious

- **Meaning:** Assuming power or authority without justification; arrogant and domineering.
- **Usage 1:** An **imperious** attitude from a team lead destroys project morale.
- **Usage 2:** He issued an **imperious** command requiring everyone to cancel their weekend plans.

80. Quixotic

- **Meaning:** Exceedingly idealistic; unrealistic and impractical.
- **Usage 1:** Hoping to build an alternative to Google in a single weekend is a **quixotic** idea.
- **Usage 2:** While noble, his **quixotic** attempt to eliminate all corporate hierarchy failed.

81. Compendious

- **Meaning:** Presenting essential facts in a comprehensive but concise way.
- **Usage 1:** The training documentation provides a **compendious** look at Python programming.

- **Usage 2:** He gave a **compendious** report on the system migration process.

82. Deleterious

- **Meaning:** Causing harm or damage.
- **Usage 1:** Sitting for long hours without breaks can have a **deleterious** effect on health.
- **Usage 2:** Pushing unverified updates to production has **deleterious** consequences.

83. Diligent

- **Meaning:** Showing care and conscientiousness in one's work or duties.
- **Usage 1:** Thanks to **diligent** efforts by the security team, the malware attack was blocked.
- **Usage 2:** A **diligent** student reviews programming concepts every day.

84. Exemplary

- **Meaning:** Serving as a desirable model; representing the best of its kind.
- **Usage 1:** TCS awarded him for his **exemplary** performance during the critical migration phase.
- **Usage 2:** Her dedication to clean code formatting is **exemplary**.

85. Inadvertent

- **Meaning:** Not resulting from or achieved through deliberate planning; accidental.
- **Usage 1:** The system deletion was entirely **inadvertent**, caused by a typo in the command line.
- **Usage 2:** An **inadvertent** omission in the email led to a major misunderstanding.

86. Indifferent

- **Meaning:** Having no particular interest or sympathy; unconcerned.
- **Usage 1:** A company cannot afford to be **indifferent** to user feedback.
- **Usage 2:** He remained completely **indifferent** to the structural changes happening in the team.

87. Meticulous

- **Meaning:** Showing great attention to detail; very careful and precise.
- **Usage 1:** Preparing code documentation requires **meticulous** attention to detail.
- **Usage 2:** The QA specialist did a **meticulous** review of the mobile application.

88. Negligent

- **Meaning:** Failing to take proper care in doing something.
- **Usage 1:** Leaving server passwords in plain text is highly **negligent** behavior.
- **Usage 2:** The vendor was penalized for being **negligent** with project delivery timelines.

89. Novel

- **Meaning:** New or unusual in an interesting way.
- **Usage 1:** The intern proposed a **novel** solution to optimize our sorting algorithm.
- **Usage 2:** Using blockchain for supply chain management was a **novel** idea a few years ago.

90. Obsolete

- **Meaning:** No longer produced or used; out of date.
- **Usage 1:** Floppy disks became completely **obsolete** after USB drives were introduced.
- **Usage 2:** Learning assembly language might feel **obsolete**, but it builds strong core concepts.

91. Plausible

- **Meaning:** Seeming reasonable or probable.
- **Usage 1:** The developer gave a **plausible** explanation for why the app crashed under heavy load.
- **Usage 2:** Is there any **plausible** alternative to using cloud databases?

92. Proficient

- **Meaning:** Competent or skilled in doing or using something.
- **Usage 1:** TCS expects CSE graduates to be highly **proficient** in data structures.
- **Usage 2:** She is quite **proficient** in managing large AWS deployments.

93. Prudent

- **Meaning:** Acting with or showing care and thought for the future; wise.
- **Usage 1:** It is **prudent** to double-check your code before committing it to production.
- **Usage 2:** A **prudent** investor spreads their money across different sectors.

94. Scrupulous

- **Meaning:** Diligent, thorough, and extremely attentive to details or ethics.
- **Usage 1:** The research team maintained **scrupulous** records of all their test results.
- **Usage 2:** A software engineer must be **scrupulous** about user data privacy.

95. Skeptical

- **Meaning:** Not easily convinced; having doubts or reservations.
- **Usage 1:** The team lead was **skeptical** about using an unverified third-party plugin.
- **Usage 2:** Investors are **skeptical** about the platform's high profit claims.

96. Stringent

- **Meaning:** Strict, precise, and exacting.
- **Usage 1:** Tech firms follow **stringent** background checks before onboarding employees.

- **Usage 2:** Code reviews became more **stringent** to ensure higher product standards.

97. Superfluous

- **Meaning:** Unnecessary, especially through being more than enough.
- **Usage 1:** Avoid adding **superfluous** lines of code that slow down program execution.
- **Usage 2:** The manager removed all **superfluous** details from the meeting agenda.

98. Systematic

- **Meaning:** Done or acting according to a fixed plan or system; methodical.
- **Usage 1:** Debugging requires a **systematic** approach rather than random guessing.
- **Usage 2:** The HR department follows a **systematic** process for hiring freshers.

99. Unethical

- **Meaning:** Not morally correct; breaking professional codes of conduct.
- **Usage 1:** Copying someone else's source code without permission is highly **unethical**.
- **Usage 2:** Selling user data to third parties without consent is an **unethical** practice.

100. Zealous

- **Meaning:** Having or showing great energy or enthusiasm for a cause or objective.
- **Usage 1:** The new batch of interns is highly **zealous** about learning cloud technologies.
- **Usage 2:** He is a **zealous** advocate for open-source software within the company.